sharing ancestry and also care about the fact that they have that supposed ancestry in common.'[217] This is very similar to what Scheffer wrote.

In another book, *Cynical Theories: How Activist Scholarship Made Everything About Race, Gender and Identity,* Helen Pluckrose and James Lindsay analyse in detail how the postmodernist philosophy of the 1960s developed a new ideology in the following decades – the theory of Social Justice (with capital letters), which prevailed in the twenty-first century in academic as well as in social discourse, especially in the field of gender issues.

Sometimes this mentality is inaccurately or superficially called liberal, but the authors – themselves advocates of liberal ideas – claim the opposite. They say that this new ideology is not about liberal tolerance and acceptance of homosexuals and various other life choices or ways of living, much less about promoting social, racial, and sexual equality. The authors show very convincingly that this dictatorship of political correctness is a far-left signature of complete opposition to classical liberalism, of imposing the only acceptable philosophical view that has grown into an ideology, almost into a religion.

This postmodernism is described by the authors as marked by radical scepticism about any possibility of objective cognition and at the same time by a commitment to cultural constructivism, and a belief that society is purely a system of power. Postmodernism, in the authors' view, blurs the boundaries, uses the language of power, and introduces cultural relativism and the loss of the individual and the universal.[218]

In the context of our discussion on sexual democracy, it is interesting to note Pluckrose's and Lindsay's criticism of the 'woke' for almost completely ignoring biology, as 'it regards the very existence of categories of sex, gender, and sexuality to be oppressive'.[219] In this area 'theory's political agenda is to challenge what is called *normativity* – that some things are more common or regular to the human condition, thus more normative from a social (thus moral) perspective, than others. The main industry of queer theorists is to intentionally conflate two meanings of "normative", and deliberately make strategic use of the moral understanding of the term to contrive problems with its descriptive meaning.'[220] This way of thinking is engaged in 'ridiculing normative sexualities and genders and depicting those who recognise them as